

The Golden Fork Restaurant

Policy Manual

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This is a sample policy document prepared for a restaurant management and question-answering system. All names, amounts and time limits are fictional and may be edited freely.

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Chapter 1: About This Manual

This Policy Manual defines the rules under which The Golden Fork Restaurant accepts reservations, assigns tables, takes and prepares orders, handles payments and refunds, and protects customer information. It is intended for customers, front-of-house staff, kitchen staff, managers and automated assistants that answer policy questions on behalf of the restaurant.

RP-1.1 Purpose of the Manual

The purpose of this manual is to give every customer and every employee one consistent, written source of truth for how the restaurant operates. Where a customer asks a question such as how late a reservation can be cancelled, what happens when a guest does not arrive, or whether an order can still be changed, the answer must come from this manual and not from personal habit or memory.

Where a matter is not covered here, the Duty Manager decides and records the decision so that the manual can be updated.

RP-1.2 Scope

This manual applies to all dine-in, takeaway and pre-booked group service at The Golden Fork Restaurant. It applies to every customer record, reservation record, order record, menu item and table recorded in the restaurant management system, and to all staff who create, change or cancel those records.

Separate rules for private events and corporate bookings are set out in Chapter 10. If a general rule and a special rule conflict, the special rule applies.

RP-1.3 How Policies Are Numbered

Each policy is identified by a reference of the form RP-C.N, where C is the chapter number and N is the clause number within that chapter. For example, RP-2.4 is the fourth clause of Chapter 2 (Reservation Booking). Staff and customers should quote the reference when discussing a policy so that everyone refers to the same text.

Dollar amounts in this manual are shown in the restaurant's billing currency using the dollar sign. All times are local restaurant time on a 24-hour or 12-hour clock as written.

RP-1.4 Relationship to the Restaurant Database

The restaurant keeps five main record types: customers, menu items, orders, reservations and restaurant tables. These records hold facts such as who a customer is, what a dish costs, when a reservation is booked and how many guests a table can seat. This manual does not repeat those facts. Instead, it explains the rules that apply to them.

As a general principle, the database answers questions of the form what or when (for example, what time is reservation R012 booked for), while this manual answers questions of the form may, must or how long (for example, may that reservation be cancelled without a fee, and how many hours of notice are required).

RP-1.5 Definitions

In this manual, the word customer means any person who has a customer record, whether or not they have yet ordered or booked. A guest is any person who dines, including children and companions of the customer. A party is the group of guests attending under one reservation or order.

A reservation is a confirmed or pending booking of a table for a stated date, time and number of guests. An order is a request for one or more menu items by a customer. A business day is any day on which the restaurant is open to the public, excluding public holidays on which it is closed. Working hours means the restaurant's published opening hours.

RP-1.6 Status of This Manual and Changes

This manual takes effect on the date shown on its cover and replaces all earlier policy documents. The restaurant may change any policy at any time. A change applies to reservations and orders made on or after the effective date of the change, unless the change is in the customer's favour, in which case it applies immediately to all existing bookings.

Material changes are announced on the restaurant's website and on a notice at the reception desk at least seven days before they take effect, except where a change is required sooner by law or for safety reasons.

RP-1.7 Interpretation and Discretion

Policies are applied fairly and consistently. A Duty Manager may, in good faith, waive a fee or relax a time limit where genuine hardship, illness, emergency, or restaurant error is involved. Any waiver must be recorded against the customer's record with the reason and the manager's name.

A waiver in one case does not create a right to the same waiver in another case. Repeated use of discretion by the same customer will be reviewed by the General Manager.

Chapter 2: Reservation Booking Policy

This chapter describes who may book, how far ahead, how many guests, and what happens when a booking is made. It is the foundation for the cancellation, late arrival and no-show rules in the following chapters.

RP-2.1 Who May Make a Reservation

A reservation may be made by any person who holds a customer record with the restaurant. A customer record contains a customer ID (for example C005), the customer's name, email address and phone number. A reservation cannot be confirmed without at least a name and one working contact method, either a phone number or an email address.

A reservation is owned by the customer who made it. Only that customer, or a person the customer has authorised in writing, may change or cancel it. Staff must not discuss the details of a reservation with a caller who cannot confirm the customer's identity under Chapter 9.

RP-2.2 Booking Channels

Reservations may be made by telephone, in person at the reception desk, through the restaurant's website, or through the restaurant's digital assistant. All channels create the same type of reservation record and are governed by the same rules.

Reservations made by email or social media message are not valid until a staff member replies with a reservation ID and a status of Confirmed.

RP-2.3 Advance Booking Window

A reservation may be made up to 60 days before the requested date. Requests for dates further ahead are placed on a waiting list and are not treated as reservations.

A reservation must be made at least 2 hours before the requested time. Same-day requests with less than 2 hours of notice are treated as walk-in requests and are accepted only if a suitable table is free.

RP-2.4 Party Size Limits

A standard reservation is for 1 to 10 guests. A party of 11 to 30 guests is a large group reservation and is subject to the Large Group Policy in Chapter 4. A party of more than 30 guests must be booked as a private event under Chapter 10.

The number of guests recorded on the reservation must include children and infants who will occupy a seat. Infants who will sit on a parent's lap are not counted, but the restaurant must be told so that a high chair can be arranged.

RP-2.5 Information Required to Book

To complete a booking the restaurant records the customer ID, the reservation date, the reservation time, the number of guests, and any special requests. The restaurant then assigns a table and a reservation ID and sets the status of the reservation.

A customer who gives false contact details, or who books under another person's name without permission, may have the reservation cancelled and may be refused future bookings.

RP-2.6 Reservation Time Slots

Reservations are taken at 15-minute intervals within the opening hours stated in Chapter 11. The last reservation of the day is accepted 90 minutes before closing time. For example, on a day when the restaurant closes at 23:00, the latest reservation time is 21:30.

Lunch service runs from opening until 15:30. Dinner service runs from 18:00 until closing. Reservations between 15:30 and 18:00 are accepted only for tea and light snacks.

RP-2.7 Dining Duration

Each reservation includes a dining period so that the table can be offered to the next party. The standard period is 90 minutes for parties of 1 to 4 guests, 120 minutes for parties of 5 to 8 guests, and 150 minutes for parties of 9 guests or more.

If no other party is waiting for the table, guests may stay longer at the discretion of the Duty Manager. If the table is needed, staff will politely tell the party 15 minutes before the end of the dining period.

RP-2.8 Reservation Confirmation

A reservation is Pending until the restaurant confirms it. The restaurant aims to confirm every request within 30 minutes during opening hours. Once confirmed, the status becomes Confirmed and the customer receives the reservation ID, the date, time, number of guests and the assigned table.

A customer should not rely on a booking that is still Pending. If a reservation remains Pending for more than 12 hours and the restaurant has not confirmed it, the customer may treat the request as declined.

RP-2.9 Reconfirmation of Reservations

For reservations of 8 guests or more, the restaurant will contact the customer 24 hours before the reservation to reconfirm. If the customer does not respond within 6 hours, a second attempt is made. If there is still no response and the reservation is less than 6 hours away, the restaurant may release the table.

For smaller parties reconfirmation is optional, but customers are encouraged to confirm by replying to the confirmation message.

RP-2.10 Maximum Active Reservations per Customer

A customer may hold no more than 3 active reservations at the same time. An active reservation is one whose status is Pending or Confirmed and whose date has not yet passed. This rule exists to stop tables being blocked by duplicate or speculative bookings.

A customer may not hold two active reservations for the same date and overlapping time. If a second booking is made for the same time slot, the earlier booking is kept and the later one is declined unless the customer asks for the earlier one to be cancelled.

RP-2.11 Special Requests

Special requests include seating preferences, high chairs, wheelchair access, birthday or anniversary arrangements, and dietary needs. Special requests are recorded against the reservation and passed to the floor team, but they are requests and not guarantees, with the exception of accessibility needs and allergy information, which the restaurant always makes every reasonable effort to meet.

A request for a specific table number cannot be guaranteed. The restaurant will try to honour it where the table has sufficient capacity and is free.

RP-2.12 Peak Periods and Public Holidays

On Friday and Saturday evenings and on public holidays and festival days, the restaurant is considered to be in a peak period. During peak periods the minimum advance booking time is increased to 4 hours, the maximum party size for a standard booking is reduced to 8 guests, and the dining period is limited to 90 minutes for parties of up to 6 guests.

The restaurant publishes the list of peak dates on its website at least 30 days in advance.

RP-2.13 Refusal of a Reservation

The restaurant may decline a reservation if no suitable table is available, if the customer has an unpaid late-cancellation or no-show fee, if the customer has been banned under the Conduct Policy, or if the reservation would breach the rules of this manual.

A declined request is not a reservation. The restaurant should offer an alternative time or date wherever possible.

Chapter 3: Reservation Changes, Cancellation and No-Show Policy

This chapter sets out the time limits, fees and consequences that apply when a customer changes a reservation, cancels it or does not arrive. These are the most frequently queried rules in the manual.

RP-3.1 Free Cancellation Period

A customer may cancel a reservation free of charge at any time up to 24 hours before the reservation time. A cancellation made 24 hours or more before the reservation carries no fee, and any deposit paid is refunded in full.

The 24 hours are counted from the booked reservation date and time, not from the time the booking was made. For example, a reservation for Saturday at 20:00 may be cancelled free of charge until Friday at 20:00.

RP-3.2 Late Cancellation

A cancellation made less than 24 hours but at least 2 hours before the reservation time is a late cancellation. A late cancellation fee of \$5 per guest applies, up to a maximum of \$50 per reservation. If a deposit was paid, the fee is deducted from the deposit and the balance is refunded.

If no deposit was paid, the fee is recorded against the customer's record and must be settled before the customer makes the next reservation.

RP-3.3 Very Late Cancellation

A cancellation made less than 2 hours before the reservation time is a very late cancellation and is charged at the no-show rate in clause RP-3.5, because the restaurant is unable to re-offer the table in time.

Exceptions apply where the customer or an immediate family member suffers a sudden illness, an accident, or a bereavement. A Duty Manager may waive the fee on presentation of reasonable evidence.

RP-3.4 How to Cancel

A cancellation may be made by telephone, in person, through the website or through the restaurant's digital assistant, quoting the reservation ID. A cancellation is effective at the moment it is received by the restaurant, not at the moment the customer attempted to reach the restaurant.

When a cancellation is accepted, the status of the reservation is changed to Cancelled and the assigned table is released for other bookings. The customer receives a cancellation confirmation. A customer who does not receive confirmation should assume the cancellation has not been processed.

RP-3.5 No-Show Policy

A no-show occurs when a party does not arrive within 15 minutes of the reservation time and has not contacted the restaurant. The reservation status is then changed to No-Show and the table is released.

A no-show fee of \$10 per guest applies, up to a maximum of \$100 per reservation. Any deposit is forfeited in place of the fee. The fee is recorded on the customer record and must be paid before any future reservation is accepted.

RP-3.6 Repeated No-Shows

A customer with two no-shows within any period of 6 months will be asked to pay a deposit of \$10 per guest for every reservation made during the following 6 months. A customer with three no-shows within 12 months may be suspended from making reservations for 90 days.

A suspension may be lifted early by the General Manager if the customer demonstrates that the missed bookings were due to circumstances outside their control.

RP-3.7 Late Arrival

The restaurant holds a table for 15 minutes after the reservation time. If the party is running late, the customer should telephone the restaurant. If the customer calls before the reservation time and says that they will be up to 30 minutes late, the restaurant will normally hold the table for that period, depending on demand.

If the party arrives after the hold period and the table has been released, the restaurant will try to seat the party at another suitable table. If none is available, the party will be offered the next available time, and the reservation will be treated as a no-show only if the party declines to wait and leaves.

RP-3.8 Late Arrival for Large Groups

For parties of 8 guests or more, the table is held for 30 minutes. Because large groups often arrive in stages, the restaurant will seat the group once at least half of the guests have arrived. The number of guests charged at the end of the booking is the number originally reserved, or the number who actually dine if the customer has reduced the number in line with RP-3.9.

If fewer than half of the guests have arrived within 30 minutes, and the customer has not contacted the restaurant, the reservation is treated as a no-show.

RP-3.9 Changing the Number of Guests

A customer may increase or reduce the number of guests on a reservation up to 4 hours before the reservation time, subject to the capacity of the assigned table. If the new number of guests exceeds the capacity of the assigned table, the restaurant will try to move the party to a larger table at the same time.

An increase of more than 2 guests requires reconfirmation by the restaurant. A reduction of the number of guests more than 24 hours before the reservation carries no fee. A reduction made less than 24 hours before is treated as a late cancellation for the guests removed, at the rate in RP-3.2.

RP-3.10 Changing the Date or Time

A customer may change the date or time of a reservation up to 4 hours before the original reservation time, provided that a suitable table is free at the new time. A change is subject to the same limit of the advance booking window in Chapter 2.

A change that moves the reservation to a time more than 24 hours after the original time is treated as a new reservation, and the old reservation is cancelled free of charge if the change request is made more than 24 hours before the original reservation.

RP-3.11 Limit on Changes

Each reservation may be changed a maximum of 2 times. A third change must be made by cancelling the reservation and booking a new one, which may be subject to the cancellation fees in this chapter.

Changes of contact details or special requests do not count as changes for the purpose of this limit.

RP-3.12 Changing the Assigned Table

A customer may ask for a different table on arrival. The restaurant will try to accommodate the request, but it cannot guarantee a particular table. The restaurant may itself change the assigned table before or on the day of the reservation if required for safety, maintenance, a larger booking, or operational reasons. The party will be moved to a table of equal or greater capacity and quality.

A change of table made by the restaurant never leads to a fee and does not count as a change under RP-3.11.

RP-3.13 Cancellation by the Restaurant

The restaurant may cancel a reservation in exceptional circumstances such as a power failure, flooding, a safety order, a private closure, or a shortage of staff. The restaurant will inform the customer as early as possible and offer an alternative date or a full refund of any deposit.

No fee is charged and the customer is entitled to a goodwill gesture decided by the Duty Manager, such as a complimentary drink or a discount on a future visit.

RP-3.14 Completed Reservations

When the party has been seated and has finished dining, the status of the reservation is changed to Completed. A Completed reservation cannot be cancelled or changed. Any later query is dealt with as a feedback or complaint under Chapter 12.

A reservation that has been seated but where the party leaves before ordering is also treated as Completed, but the Duty Manager may record a note.

RP-3.15 Reservation Status Reference

The status of a reservation shows where it is in its life cycle. The statuses are Pending (awaiting confirmation), Confirmed (accepted and table assigned), Seated (party has arrived and is being served), Completed (party has dined and left), Cancelled (cancelled by the customer or the restaurant), and No-Show (party did not arrive).

A reservation moves only forwards in this sequence, with the exception that Pending or Confirmed may become Cancelled and Confirmed may become No-Show. A Cancelled or No-Show reservation may be reinstated only by a Duty Manager within 24 hours and only if the table is still free.

Table 3-A: Reservation Cancellation Fee Summary

Time of cancellation	Fee	Deposit
24 hours or more before	None	Refunded in full
2 to 24 hours before	\$5 per guest (max \$50)	Fee deducted; balance refunded
Less than 2 hours before	\$10 per guest (max \$100)	Forfeited
No-show (after 15 min)	\$10 per guest (max \$100)	Forfeited
Cancelled by restaurant	None	Refunded in full

Chapter 4: Table Policy

This chapter explains how tables are described, assigned, combined and released, and how large groups are handled. Each table has a table ID, a table number, a capacity and a status.

RP-4.1 Table Records

Every table in the restaurant has a table ID (for example T01), a physical table number marked on the table, a maximum capacity (the largest number of guests it can seat comfortably) and a status. Staff must keep the status of each table accurate throughout service.

The capacity of a table is a safety and comfort limit. It must never be exceeded, even if the guests offer to sit closely together.

RP-4.2 Table Capacity Rules

The restaurant has tables of 2, 4, 6 and 8 seats. A table is assigned to a reservation only if its capacity is equal to or greater than the number of guests. To make good use of the dining room, the restaurant avoids assigning a table that has more than two spare seats unless no smaller table is free.

A party of 2 will normally be offered a 2-seat table. A party of 3 or 4 will be offered a 4-seat table. A party of 5 or 6 will be offered a 6-seat table, and a party of 7 or 8 will be offered an 8-seat table.

RP-4.3 Table Statuses

A table may be Available (free and ready), Reserved (held for a confirmed reservation), Occupied (party seated), Cleaning (being cleaned and reset) or Maintenance (out of service). Only an Available table may be assigned to a new reservation or a walk-in party.

A table that has been marked Reserved reverts to Available if the reservation is cancelled, or 15 minutes after the reservation time if the party has not arrived, in line with the no-show policy.

RP-4.4 Table Assignment Procedure

When a reservation is confirmed, the restaurant assigns a table by considering the number of guests, the requested time, accessibility needs, the position of the table and the expected dining period of earlier bookings. The table ID is recorded on the reservation.

The assignment is provisional until the party arrives. The restaurant may reassign a table at any time under RP-3.12 if the reassigned table has equal or greater capacity.

RP-4.5 Combining Tables

Where a party is larger than the capacity of a single table, two or more adjoining tables may be combined. Combined tables may seat up to the sum of their capacities, minus one seat per join where space is limited. Combined tables must be requested at least 24 hours in advance, because they remove more than one table from the floor plan.

Combining tables is at the discretion of the Duty Manager and may not be possible during peak periods.

RP-4.6 Large Group Policy

A large group is a party of 11 to 30 guests. A large group reservation must be made at least 72 hours in advance, and a deposit of \$15 per guest is payable within 48 hours of the booking being accepted. Without the deposit, the reservation will be cancelled.

Large groups choose from a set menu or a limited à la carte menu, which must be agreed with the restaurant at least 48 hours before the reservation. A service charge of 10 percent is added to the bill of every party of 6 or more guests.

RP-4.7 Large Group Cancellation

A large group reservation may be cancelled free of charge up to 7 days before the reservation, and the deposit will be refunded in full. A cancellation made between 3 and 7 days before the reservation forfeits 50 percent of the deposit. A cancellation made less than 3 days before the reservation forfeits the entire deposit.

The number of guests may be reduced by up to 20 percent without penalty up to 48 hours before the reservation. A larger reduction is charged at 50 percent of the deposit per guest removed.

RP-4.8 Outdoor and Special Seating

Outdoor seating is offered when the weather permits and cannot be guaranteed. If the weather turns bad, the restaurant will move the party indoors, and no fee is charged. A request for outdoor seating is a preference only.

Booths and window tables are limited. They are allocated to parties in the order in which the reservations were received, but a Duty Manager may give priority to guests with accessibility needs.

RP-4.9 Accessibility and Table Assignment

Guests with limited mobility, wheelchair users, and guests who are visually or hearing impaired will be seated at tables that suit their needs. The restaurant keeps at least two tables near the entrance for wheelchair users, and these tables are not given to other parties unless all other tables are full.

Guests who need assistance should say so when booking, but they will also be assisted on arrival if they did not.

RP-4.10 Walk-In Guests

Guests without a reservation are welcome and are seated in the order they arrive, subject to the availability of an Available table. A walk-in party is not given a table that has been marked Reserved unless the reservation time is more than 2 hours away and the party agrees to leave by that time.

The restaurant may keep a waiting list. Estimated waiting times are only estimates.

RP-4.11 Waiting Area and Bar Seating

Parties waiting for a table are welcome to wait in the waiting area or at the bar. The restaurant cannot guarantee how long a wait will be. Waiting parties will be called in the order they arrived, with the exception that smaller tables may be allocated to smaller parties first if a larger table is not yet free.

Bar seating is available on a first-come basis and cannot be reserved.

RP-4.12 Table Turnover and Dining Period

To ensure fair access, each table is offered for the dining period in RP-2.7. The restaurant will not rush guests, but may ask guests to move to the waiting area or bar to finish their drinks if another party is waiting.

The restaurant may not charge guests for staying beyond the dining period, but it reserves the right to charge a table fee of \$10 per guest per additional 30 minutes during peak periods when a party refuses a polite request to vacate a table needed for a later booking.

RP-4.13 Table Maintenance and Closures

A table is placed in Maintenance if it is damaged, unsafe or being deep-cleaned. A table in Maintenance cannot be assigned. If a table on which a reservation is already assigned goes into Maintenance, the restaurant will reassign the reservation to another table of equal or greater capacity, and will inform the customer if the new table is in a different area of the restaurant.

If no replacement table is available, the reservation is treated as cancelled by the restaurant under RP-3.13.

Table 4-A: Table Capacity and Recommended Party Size

Table capacity	Recommended party size	Typical use
2 seats	1 to 2 guests	Couples, solo diners
4 seats	3 to 4 guests	Small families, friends
6 seats	5 to 6 guests	Families, colleagues
8 seats	7 to 8 guests	Celebrations, extended families
Combined tables	9 to 30 guests	Large groups (advance notice)

Chapter 5: Order Policy

This chapter explains how food and drink orders are placed, changed, cancelled and tracked. Each order records an order ID, the customer ID, the menu item ordered, the quantity, the date and time of the order and its status.

RP-5.1 Placing an Order

An order may be placed at the table with a member of the service team, at the counter for takeaway, by telephone or through the restaurant's website or digital assistant. Each order is recorded with an order ID, the customer ID, each menu item and quantity, and the date and time at which it was placed.

An order is accepted only for items that are marked as available on the menu. If an item becomes unavailable after an order has been placed, the restaurant will tell the customer and offer a substitute or remove the item.

RP-5.2 Minimum and Maximum Quantities

The minimum quantity of any item is 1. For any single order, the maximum quantity of any one item is 20, unless the kitchen agrees to a larger quantity in advance. Orders for more than 50 portions in total must be placed at least 24 hours in advance.

Quantities cannot be negative or fractional. Half portions are available only for items marked as such on the menu.

RP-5.3 Order Statuses

An order moves through these statuses: Pending (received but not yet accepted by the kitchen), Confirmed (accepted by the kitchen), Preparing (being cooked), Ready (cooked and waiting to be served or collected), Completed (served or collected, and paid) and Cancelled (withdrawn or declined).

The status of an order is updated by the kitchen and floor team. A customer who asks about their order is given the current status.

RP-5.4 Modifying an Order

A customer may add items, remove items or change quantities while the order is Pending, and for up to 5 minutes after the order has been placed if it is Confirmed, provided that the kitchen has not started preparing the affected item.

Once an order is Preparing, items that have already been started cannot be changed, but the customer may add new items, which are treated as a new order for the purposes of status and billing.

RP-5.5 Cancelling an Order

A customer may cancel an order free of charge while it is Pending, or while it is Confirmed and the kitchen has not started preparation. When the order is cancelled, its status is changed to Cancelled and the customer is not charged.

An order whose status is Preparing, Ready or Completed cannot be cancelled by the customer. If the food is not as ordered, or is not acceptable, the customer may make a complaint under Chapter 12.

RP-5.6 Cancellation After Preparation Has Started

If the customer cancels an order after preparation has started, the restaurant may charge up to 100 percent of the price of the items that have already been cooked. Where the customer cancels because the restaurant has been unreasonably slow, defined in RP-5.9, no charge is made.

A Duty Manager may waive the charge where the order was cancelled because of illness, an emergency, or where the cancellation does not lead to food waste, for example because another guest agrees to take the dish.

RP-5.7 Order Processing Times

The restaurant aims to serve starters and drinks within 15 minutes, and main courses within 30 minutes, of the order being Confirmed. Times may be longer when the restaurant is busy, and for dishes marked as slow-cooked on the menu, which take up to 45 minutes.

The service team will update customers whose order is delayed beyond these times.

RP-5.8 Order Sequence and Courses

Unless the customer asks otherwise, starters are served first, followed by main courses, then desserts. Customers who prefer all courses together should say so when ordering. Drinks are served as soon as they are ready.

Orders from the same table are served in the order they were placed, except where a kitchen constraint means that an item must be served earlier or later.

RP-5.9 Delayed Orders

An order is delayed if it has not been served within 20 minutes after the target time in RP-5.7. The service team must apologise, tell the customer the reason for the delay and give a new estimate. If the delay continues for a further 15 minutes, the customer may cancel the order without charge or accept a complimentary drink.

Repeated delays on the same order are reported to the Duty Manager.

RP-5.10 Incorrect or Missing Items

If an item arrives that the customer did not order, or an item is missing, the customer must tell the service team immediately. The restaurant will correct the error at no charge. An incorrect item must be removed from the bill.

A customer who finds a mistake after leaving the restaurant should contact the restaurant within 24 hours, quoting the order ID.

RP-5.11 Takeaway Orders

A takeaway order may be placed by telephone, online or at the counter. The customer will be given an estimated collection time. A takeaway order that has not been collected within 45 minutes of the ready time may be discarded, and no refund is given unless the delay was caused by the restaurant.

Takeaway packaging is included in the price of the food and is not charged separately.

RP-5.12 Delivery Orders

Delivery is available within the restaurant's delivery area for orders over \$20. A delivery charge of \$3 applies to orders under \$40. Delivery times are estimates, and the restaurant is not responsible for delays caused by weather, traffic or a customer giving an incorrect address.

If the customer is not available to receive a delivery within 10 minutes of the driver's arrival, the order is treated as Completed and no refund is given.

RP-5.13 Orders Linked to Reservations

A customer who has a reservation may pre-order food in advance. A pre-order is attached to the reservation and does not start preparation until the party arrives, unless the customer asks the kitchen to have the food ready for the reservation time. If the reservation is cancelled, the pre-order is cancelled under the same terms.

If the party does not arrive and the kitchen has already started preparation at the customer's request, the restaurant may charge for the food prepared.

RP-5.14 Order History and Records

The restaurant keeps a record of every order. A customer may ask for a copy of their orders at any time, subject to identity verification under Chapter 9. Orders are retained for 24 months, after which they are anonymised.

Cancelled orders are retained with the status Cancelled so that refunds and disputes can be investigated.

RP-5.15 Group Orders and Split Bills

At a table of up to 6 guests, the bill may be split up to 4 ways. For tables of more than 6 guests, the bill may be split between no more than 2 payers, because the service charge applies to the whole bill. Itemised splits are available if requested before the order is closed.

Orders placed under one customer ID but paid by another person are the responsibility of the customer who placed the order.

Table 5-A: When an Order Can Be Changed or Cancelled

Order status	Modify?	Cancel?	Charge?
Pending	Yes	Yes	None
Confirmed (not started)	Within 5 minutes	Yes	None
Preparing	Add only	Not by customer	Up to 100% of prepared items
Ready	No	No	Full price
Completed	No	No	Complaint route only
Cancelled	No	Already cancelled	None

Chapter 6: Menu and Pricing Policy

This chapter explains the rules on the menu, including availability, pricing, categories, ingredients and substitutions. Each menu item has an item ID, a name, a category, a price and an availability flag.

RP-6.1 Menu Items and Categories

Every dish and drink on the menu is recorded as a menu item with an item ID, a name, a category, a price and an availability setting. The menu is divided into the following categories: Starters, Main Courses, Breads and Sides, Desserts, Beverages and Specials.

A menu item belongs to exactly one category. The category determines the order in which the items are shown, and may affect the course in which they are served.

RP-6.2 Item Availability

An item is available when it is marked as available in the system. An item that is not available cannot be ordered. The restaurant may mark an item as not available at any time because of ingredient shortage, equipment failure, quality concerns, or because the item is seasonal.

If a customer has ordered an item that has become unavailable, the restaurant must tell them before the food is prepared and offer a similar item of equal or lower price.

RP-6.3 Out-of-Stock Items

If the kitchen runs out of an ingredient during service, the affected items are marked as not available immediately. The restaurant will not substitute a different ingredient of lower quality without telling the customer.

Items marked as not available remain on the printed menu but are removed from digital ordering, and the service team will inform customers when they ask.

RP-6.4 Prices

All prices are in the restaurant's billing currency and are shown on the menu. Prices exclude applicable taxes unless the menu says otherwise. The price on the menu at the time the order is placed is the price that is charged, even if the price is later changed.

The restaurant may change prices at any time. Changes to printed menus take effect when a new menu is issued, and changes to the digital menu take effect immediately for new orders.

RP-6.5 Pricing Errors

If an obvious pricing error is made on the menu, such as a price that is much lower than the cost of the dish, the restaurant may correct the price and will inform the customer before the order is prepared. The customer may then keep or cancel the order without charge.

If the error is found after the item has been served, the restaurant will honour the price on the menu at the time of the order.

RP-6.6 Taxes and Service Charge

Government taxes are added to the bill at the rate required by law and are shown as a separate line. A service charge of 10 percent is added for parties of 6 or more guests and for large groups. A service charge is not added for smaller parties, but guests may leave a gratuity.

A service charge is shared among the service team. A customer who is dissatisfied with the service may ask the Duty Manager to review the service charge under Chapter 12.

RP-6.7 Specials and Seasonal Items

Specials are dishes that are not on the standard menu and are available for a limited time. Specials are priced and recorded in the same way as other items but are subject to availability, and may be withdrawn without notice.

Seasonal items are offered for a season and are removed when the ingredients are no longer available at the quality required by the restaurant.

RP-6.8 Portion Sizes and Presentation

Photographs on menus and websites are for illustration, and the presentation and portion size may differ slightly. The restaurant standardises portion sizes by recipe. A portion is intended for one person unless the menu says that it is for sharing.

A customer who feels a portion is much smaller than the standard may ask the Duty Manager to check it against the recipe.

RP-6.9 Substitutions and Customisation

Customers may ask for reasonable changes to a dish, for example removing an ingredient or choosing a different side. The kitchen will try to accommodate requests where it does not change the nature of the dish. Substitutions that cost the restaurant more may be charged at an extra cost shown to the customer before the order is confirmed.

Changes to a dish after preparation has begun are treated as modifications under RP-5.4.

RP-6.10 Children's Menu

A children's menu is available for children aged 12 and under. Children's portions are priced lower than adult portions. Children's dishes are intended for children and cannot be ordered for adults except at the discretion of the Duty Manager.

Infants under 2 eat free of charge when sharing food with a parent.

RP-6.11 Beverage Policy

Non-alcoholic beverages are available to all guests. Alcohol is served only to guests over the legal drinking age, and the restaurant may ask for proof of age. The restaurant may refuse to serve alcohol to any guest who appears intoxicated.

Bringing your own beverages is not permitted, with the exception of baby milk and medically required drinks.

RP-6.12 Menu Updates

The menu is reviewed every quarter. Changes are made in the system by the kitchen manager and take effect on the stated date. A list of changes is displayed at reception for 14 days.

Customers with pre-orders for a date after the change will be told of any changes that affect their order.

Table 6-A: Menu Categories

Category	Typical service course	Typical preparation time
Starters	First course	10 to 15 minutes
Main Courses	Second course	20 to 30 minutes
Breads and Sides	With main courses	5 to 10 minutes
Desserts	Final course	10 minutes
Beverages	On request	2 to 5 minutes
Specials	As advised	As advised

Chapter 7: Refund Policy

This chapter sets out when the restaurant will return money to customers, how long it takes, and how refunds are recorded. It applies to deposits, orders, delivery charges and fees.

RP-7.1 General Principles

The restaurant refunds money when it is owed under this manual, when the restaurant has made an error, or when the customer is entitled to a refund by law. A refund is always made to the person who paid, and in the same way that they paid, unless the person asks for a different method and the restaurant agrees.

A refund is never made in cash if the original payment was made by card, in order to prevent fraud.

RP-7.2 Refunds for Cancelled Reservations

Where a deposit has been paid for a reservation and the reservation is cancelled 24 hours or more before the reservation time, the deposit is refunded in full. Where the cancellation is made less than 24 hours before, the fees in Chapter 3 are deducted and the remainder of the deposit is refunded.

A no-show forfeits the deposit. Where the restaurant cancels a reservation, the deposit is refunded in full.

RP-7.3 Refunds for Cancelled Orders

An order that is cancelled while it is Pending, or when it is Confirmed but has not been started, is refunded in full if it has been paid for in advance. An order that is cancelled after it has been started is refunded minus the amount that the restaurant may charge under RP-5.6.

Refunds for takeaway and delivery orders that have been paid for online are made to the card or account used for payment.

RP-7.4 Refunds for Unsatisfactory Food

If a dish is not as described, is not cooked properly, contains a foreign object, or is otherwise unsatisfactory, the customer should tell the service team before the dish is eaten, or as soon as the problem is noticed. The restaurant will replace the dish, offer an alternative or remove it from the bill.

A customer who has eaten most of the dish and then complains will be asked to explain why the problem was not mentioned earlier. The Duty Manager decides whether a refund is appropriate.

RP-7.5 Refunds for Food Safety Incidents

If a customer suffers a food-related illness that they believe was caused by food from the restaurant, they should tell the restaurant as soon as possible. The restaurant will take the report seriously, investigate it, and refund the cost of the relevant meal in full while the investigation is carried out.

The restaurant will co-operate with the public health authority.

RP-7.6 Refunds for Delivery Problems

If a delivery order does not arrive, or arrives more than 45 minutes after the estimated time without explanation, the customer is entitled to a full refund of the order and the delivery charge. If the order arrives with items missing, the cost of the missing items is refunded.

A delivery that cannot be completed because the customer gave the wrong address or was not available is not refunded.

RP-7.7 Refund Processing Times

Refunds to a card or bank account are initiated within 2 business days of approval and usually appear in the customer's account within 5 to 7 business days, depending on the bank. Refunds by cash for cash payments are made at the restaurant on the same day.

The restaurant is not responsible for delays caused by the customer's bank or card provider.

RP-7.8 Refund Approval Limits

A member of the floor team may approve a refund of up to \$25. A Duty Manager may approve refunds of up to \$200. Refunds above \$200 require the approval of the General Manager. Every refund must be recorded with the order ID or reservation ID, the amount, the reason and the name of the approver.

No member of staff may approve a refund for their own order or the order of a family member.

RP-7.9 Non-Refundable Items

The following are not refundable unless required by law: late-cancellation fees and no-show fees that have been correctly charged, service charges on food that has been consumed, gift cards that have been used, and the delivery charge for deliveries that were made correctly.

Deposits for large group reservations are non-refundable to the extent described in RP-4.7.

RP-7.10 Refund Disputes

A customer who disagrees with a refund decision may ask for it to be reviewed by the General Manager. The request must be made in writing within 30 days. The General Manager will reply within 10 business days.

If the customer is still not satisfied, the customer may seek help from the local consumer protection authority.

RP-7.11 Chargebacks

A customer who asks their bank for a chargeback on a payment that has been correctly charged under this manual may be asked to settle the amount and may be refused future reservations until the matter is resolved. The restaurant will provide evidence to the bank, including the reservation or order record and the policy that applies.

Customers are encouraged to contact the restaurant first so that problems can be resolved quickly.

RP-7.12 Vouchers and Credits

Instead of a refund the restaurant may, with the customer's agreement, issue a voucher or credit. A voucher is valid for 12 months and may be used only at the restaurant. A voucher may not be exchanged for cash, except where required by law.

A credit is recorded on the customer's record and is deducted from the next bill.

Table 7-A: Refund Approval Levels

Refund amount	Approved by	Record required
Up to \$25	Floor team member	Order or reservation ID, reason
\$25.01 to \$200	Duty Manager	Order or reservation ID, reason, name
Above \$200	General Manager	Written approval, full record

Chapter 8: Payment and Billing Policy

This chapter sets out how the restaurant takes payment, issues bills and handles deposits, split bills and payment problems.

RP-8.1 Accepted Payment Methods

The restaurant accepts cash, major debit and credit cards, digital wallets and bank transfers for advance payments. The restaurant does not accept personal cheques. Foreign currency is accepted only at the discretion of the Duty Manager and at the exchange rate displayed at the cash desk.

The restaurant may ask for identification when a card is used.

RP-8.2 When Payment Is Due

For dine-in orders payment is due at the end of the meal. For takeaway orders, payment is due when the order is placed or when it is collected. For delivery orders, payment is due at the time of the order if paid online, or on delivery if paying by cash or card.

Large group reservations require a deposit as described in Chapter 4, and the balance is due at the end of the meal.

RP-8.3 Deposits

A deposit is required for large group reservations, private events, peak-period bookings for more than 8 guests, and for customers who have been subject to the repeated no-show rule in RP-3.6. The deposit is deducted from the final bill.

A deposit is refundable only as set out in Chapters 3, 4 and 7.

RP-8.4 Itemised Bills

Every bill shows each item, quantity and price, the subtotal, taxes, any service charge, any discount, and the total. A customer may ask for an itemised bill, or for a bill to be issued in the name of a business, at the time of payment.

Corrections to a bill must be made before payment has been made. After payment, corrections are dealt with as refunds under Chapter 7.

RP-8.5 Discounts and Promotions

Only one discount or promotion may be applied to a bill, unless the terms of the promotion say otherwise. Promotions are subject to the terms stated at the time. Discounts cannot be applied after payment.

Staff discounts and complimentary items may be given only by a Duty Manager and must be recorded.

RP-8.6 Gift Cards and Vouchers

Gift cards may be bought at the reception desk and online. A gift card is valid for 12 months from the date of purchase. It can be used for food and drink but not to pay gratuities or the service charge. A lost gift card cannot be replaced unless the customer can show the purchase receipt and the card number.

Vouchers issued under RP-7.12 may be used only once.

RP-8.7 Tipping

Tips are voluntary. Tips left on card payments are paid in full to the service team. The restaurant does not deduct any amount from tips except for card processing costs where required by law.

No member of staff may ask a customer for a tip.

RP-8.8 Unpaid Bills

A customer who is unable or unwilling to pay will be asked to speak to the Duty Manager. If the matter cannot be resolved, the restaurant may keep the customer's details and refer the matter to the authorities. The customer record may be flagged, and future reservations may be refused until the amount has been paid.

Staff must never detain a customer physically.

RP-8.9 Payment Errors

If a customer is charged twice, or for the wrong amount, they should tell the restaurant as soon as possible. The restaurant will check its records and correct the error within 5 business days, either by refunding the difference or by reversing the charge.

The customer should keep their receipt and, where possible, quote the order ID.

RP-8.10 Fees Recorded on the Customer Record

Late-cancellation fees, no-show fees and other charges that remain unpaid are recorded on the customer record. A customer who has an unpaid fee may not make a new reservation until it is settled, or until a deposit equal to the unpaid fee has been given.

Fees are settled by card or cash at the restaurant, or online.

Chapter 9: Customer Information and Privacy Policy

This chapter describes what personal information the restaurant keeps about customers, how it is used, who may see it, and the rights of customers regarding it.

RP-9.1 Information the Restaurant Collects

For each customer, the restaurant keeps a customer ID, the customer's name, email address and phone number. The restaurant also records reservations, orders, special requests, dietary needs and allergy information that the customer chooses to give, and any fees owed.

The restaurant collects only the information needed to take reservations, prepare orders, contact customers and keep the restaurant running.

RP-9.2 How Information Is Used

Customer information is used to confirm and manage reservations, to prepare and serve orders, to contact customers about changes, to process payments and refunds, to deal with complaints, to meet legal obligations, and to improve the restaurant's service.

Information is not sold. The restaurant sends marketing messages only to customers who have agreed to receive them, and every message includes a way to unsubscribe.

RP-9.3 Who May See Customer Information

Only staff who need the information to do their jobs may see it. Floor and reception staff may see a customer's name, reservation details and special requests. Managers may see the full record, including fees and notes. Kitchen staff may see only allergy and dietary information related to an order.

Staff must not share customer information with anyone outside the restaurant, other than as described in RP-9.4.

RP-9.4 Disclosure to Third Parties

The restaurant discloses information only to payment processors, to delivery partners (name, phone and address only), to technology providers who help to run the booking and ordering systems under a duty of confidentiality, and to the authorities where the law requires.

The restaurant will not tell a person who is not the customer whether a particular customer has a reservation, even if the caller says that they are a friend or family member.

RP-9.5 Verifying a Customer's Identity

Before the restaurant shows, changes or cancels a customer's record, reservation or order, it must verify the customer's identity. A caller is verified by giving their customer ID together with either the phone number or the email address on the record. If the caller cannot do this, the restaurant will not give information about the record.

For high-value requests, such as the refund of a deposit over \$100, the restaurant may ask for additional proof.

RP-9.6 Reservation Ownership and Privacy

A reservation belongs to the customer whose customer ID is recorded on it. Other members of the party have no right to change or cancel the reservation unless the customer has authorised them. The restaurant will tell any caller who is not the owner that it is unable to discuss the booking and invite them to ask the customer to contact the restaurant.

If a customer wants someone else to manage their reservation, they should tell the restaurant in writing and give that person's name and phone number.

RP-9.7 Updating Contact Information

Customers are asked to keep their contact details up to date. A customer may change their name, email address or phone number at any time by contacting the restaurant and verifying their identity under RP-9.5. Changes take effect immediately and apply to future communications.

Changing contact details does not affect existing reservations and orders.

RP-9.8 Customer Rights

A customer may ask to see the personal information that the restaurant holds about them, to have mistakes corrected, to have their information deleted where it is no longer needed, and to stop receiving marketing messages. The restaurant will reply to such requests within 30 days.

Information needed for legal, tax or safety reasons, including records of unpaid fees and food safety incidents, cannot be deleted before the end of the retention period.

RP-9.9 Data Retention

Customer records are kept while the customer remains active and for 24 months after the last reservation or order. After this time the personal details are deleted or anonymised. Records of payments are kept for 7 years as required by tax law.

Customers who ask to be deleted will have their details removed within 30 days, subject to RP-9.8.

RP-9.10 Security of Information

The restaurant protects customer information with access controls, passwords, encryption and staff training. Paper records are kept in a locked cabinet and shredded when they are no longer needed. If a security breach is found that is likely to put customers at risk, the restaurant will tell the affected customers and the authorities without delay.

Staff must report any suspected breach to the General Manager at once.

RP-9.11 Children's Information

The restaurant does not knowingly create customer records for children under 16. Reservations for parties that include children are made in the name of an adult.

Where a child's allergy or dietary information is recorded, it is recorded under the adult's record and is used only to prepare safe food.

RP-9.12 CCTV and Photography

The restaurant uses CCTV cameras at the entrance, in the car park and in the service areas for the safety of customers and staff. Cameras are not placed in toilets. Recordings are kept for 30 days unless needed for an investigation.

Photographs for marketing are taken only with the consent of the people in them. Guests who do not wish to be photographed should tell a member of staff.

Chapter 10: Private Events and Corporate Bookings

This chapter applies to bookings that are larger than a standard reservation or that involve exclusive use of part or all of the restaurant. Where this chapter conflicts with an earlier chapter, this chapter applies.

RP-10.1 What Counts as a Private Event

A private event is any booking of more than 30 guests, any booking that involves the exclusive use of a room or of the whole restaurant, and any booking for which the customer wants custom decoration, entertainment or a bespoke menu. Birthday parties, weddings, receptions, corporate dinners and conferences are all private events.

Private events are managed by the events coordinator and not by the front desk.

RP-10.2 Enquiry and Proposal

A private event enquiry should be made at least 14 days before the event, and preferably 30 days or more. The events coordinator will give a written proposal that sets out the date, the time, the space, the number of guests, the menu, the price, the deposit and the cancellation terms.

A proposal is valid for 7 days. A date is not held for a customer until the deposit is received.

RP-10.3 Deposits and Payment Schedule

A deposit of 30 percent of the estimated total is payable within 7 days of acceptance of the proposal. A second payment of 50 percent is due 14 days before the event. The balance is due at the end of the event.

If the deposit is not received on time, the date may be released.

RP-10.4 Event Cancellation

A private event may be cancelled free of charge, other than any costs that the restaurant has already incurred, up to 30 days before the event. A cancellation between 14 and 30 days before the event forfeits the deposit. A cancellation less than 14 days before the event is charged at 75 percent of the estimated total. A cancellation less than 48 hours before is charged at 100 percent.

If the restaurant has to cancel because of an event of force majeure, all payments will be refunded in full.

RP-10.5 Changes to Guest Numbers

The final number of guests must be confirmed 7 days before the event. The customer will be charged for the number confirmed or the number who attend, whichever is greater. An increase of up to 10 percent after confirmation will be accommodated where possible.

A reduction after confirmation will not reduce the charge.

RP-10.6 Menus and Dietary Requirements

Event menus must be agreed at least 7 days before the event. Dietary requirements and allergies of guests must be given at the same time. The restaurant will prepare alternatives for guests who have given notice, but cannot promise to meet requests made on the day.

No food or beverage may be brought into an event without the written consent of the events coordinator. A cake fee of \$3 per guest applies to cakes brought from outside.

RP-10.7 Decorations, Music and Equipment

Decorations may be placed only with the agreement of the events coordinator. Open flames, confetti, glitter, and fixings that damage walls or furniture are not permitted. Amplified music is permitted only until 22:00, and at a volume that does not disturb other customers or neighbours.

The customer is responsible for damage to the restaurant or its contents caused by the customer or the guests, and will be charged for repair.

RP-10.8 Event Timing

A private event includes access to the space for the period stated in the proposal. The customer may have 60 minutes before the event for setting up, and must leave the space within 30 minutes after the end of the event. An extra period is charged at \$100 per hour.

The restaurant is obliged to close at the licensed closing time and cannot extend the event past it.

RP-10.9 Corporate Accounts

A company may open a corporate account. The company will receive a monthly invoice, payable within 30 days. Corporate accounts are subject to a credit check and the restaurant may ask for a deposit or a guarantee.

Corporate customers have the same rights as other customers under Chapters 3, 4 and 7, unless the corporate agreement states otherwise.

RP-10.10 Liability

The restaurant is responsible for the safety of the premises and for the quality of its food. It is not responsible for the loss of or damage to belongings left on the premises, except where this is caused by its negligence. Customers should keep their valuables with them.

Nothing in this manual limits any liability that cannot be excluded by law.

Chapter 11: General Restaurant Rules

This chapter sets out the day-to-day rules that apply to every guest on the premises, including opening hours, dress, behaviour, children, pets and safety.

RP-11.1 Opening Hours

The restaurant is open Monday to Thursday from 11:00 to 23:00, Friday and Saturday from 11:00 to 00:00, and Sunday from 10:00 to 22:00. The kitchen takes its last order 45 minutes before closing time. The bar takes its last order 30 minutes before closing time.

On public holidays the opening hours may differ. They are published on the website and at the entrance at least 7 days in advance.

RP-11.2 Closing Procedure

At closing time, guests who are still dining will be allowed to finish their meal, but no new orders will be accepted after the last order time. Guests are asked to leave within 30 minutes of closing time.

The restaurant may close early because of low demand, an emergency or a private event, and will tell customers who have reservations as early as possible.

RP-11.3 Dress Code

The restaurant has a smart-casual dress code. Guests are asked to wear a shirt and footwear. Swimwear, bare chests and clothing with offensive slogans are not permitted. On special occasions the restaurant may ask for formal dress, and will say so when the booking is made.

Religious dress and cultural dress are always welcome.

RP-11.4 Behaviour of Guests

Guests are expected to treat staff and other guests with courtesy. The restaurant will not tolerate abusive, threatening, discriminatory or violent behaviour, intoxication that disturbs others, or damage to property. The Duty Manager may ask any guest who behaves in this way to leave, and no refund is due.

The restaurant may refuse future bookings from a customer who has been asked to leave.

RP-11.5 Children

Children are welcome at the restaurant. High chairs and booster seats are available on request and, if possible, should be requested at the time of booking. Children must be supervised by an adult at all times, and must not run in the dining room.

After 21:00, children under 12 must be accompanied by an adult at the table, and the restaurant may ask families with young children to sit in the family area.

RP-11.6 Pets and Service Animals

Pets are not allowed in the dining room, except for guide dogs and registered service animals, which are always welcome. Pets are welcome in the outdoor seating area if they are on a lead and well behaved.

A customer who needs a service animal does not have to give notice, but it helps the restaurant to choose a suitable table.

RP-11.7 Smoking and Vaping

Smoking and vaping are not allowed anywhere inside the restaurant. Guests may smoke only in the area marked for smoking, which is away from the entrance and the outdoor dining area.

Staff will ask guests who smoke inside to stop. A fine may be charged if a smoke alarm is set off.

RP-11.8 Mobile Phones and Noise

Guests are asked to keep mobile phones on silent and to take calls outside. Guests may not play music or videos aloud. The restaurant may ask guests to reduce their noise if it disturbs others.

Professional photography and filming in the dining room require the permission of the Duty Manager.

RP-11.9 Lost Property

Items found in the restaurant are logged and kept for 30 days. A customer who has lost an item should contact the restaurant, give a description and, if necessary, prove that it is theirs. Items that are not claimed within 30 days are given to charity, except for valuables, which are given to the police.

The restaurant is not responsible for items left on the premises.

RP-11.10 Health and Safety

The restaurant complies with all food safety, fire safety and occupational health laws. Fire exits are kept clear. Guests should follow staff instructions in an emergency. Staff are trained in first aid and the restaurant has a first aid kit and a defibrillator on the premises.

Guests who are unwell are asked not to visit the restaurant.

RP-11.11 Allergy and Dietary Information

The 14 major allergens are shown on the menu. Guests with allergies must tell the service team before ordering, and the team will tell the kitchen. The restaurant cannot guarantee that any dish is completely free of allergens, because the kitchen handles nuts, gluten, dairy, eggs, soy, fish and shellfish.

Vegetarian, vegan, halal and gluten-free options are marked on the menu. Halal and vegetarian preparation areas are kept separate.

RP-11.12 Alcohol Policy

Alcohol is served to guests aged 21 and over. The restaurant may ask for proof of age and may refuse to serve any guest if they cannot provide it. The restaurant has the right to stop serving alcohol to any guest who appears to be intoxicated, and may ask them to leave.

The restaurant may recommend taxi services to guests who have been drinking.

RP-11.13 Wi-Fi and Charging

Free Wi-Fi is available to guests. The code is shown on the menu. The restaurant does not guarantee the speed or availability of the connection and accepts no responsibility for the security of devices.

Charging points are available at selected tables and on request.

RP-11.14 Parking and Transport

Parking is available in the restaurant's car park for the duration of the visit. A maximum of 3 hours is allowed. The restaurant is not responsible for loss or damage to vehicles or their contents.

Valet service is available on Friday and Saturday evenings for a fee of \$5.

Chapter 12: Customer Service, Feedback and Complaints

This chapter explains how customers can ask for help, give feedback and make complaints, and how the restaurant must respond.

RP-12.1 Contacting the Restaurant

Customers may contact the restaurant by telephone during opening hours, by email at any time, by visiting reception or through the website. Emails received outside opening hours are answered within one business day. Enquiries made by telephone are answered at once or called back within 2 hours.

Urgent matters, such as a same-day reservation change, should be made by telephone.

RP-12.2 Customer Service Standards

Staff must greet every guest within 2 minutes of their arrival, be polite and helpful, and use the guest's name when it is known. Staff must not argue with customers. Where they cannot help, they must refer the matter to the Duty Manager rather than refuse.

Staff must be able to explain the reservation, order and refund rules in this manual to customers in plain language.

RP-12.3 Feedback

The restaurant welcomes comments on food, service and the atmosphere. Feedback may be given in person, by email, through a card on the table or online. Feedback is reviewed weekly by the General Manager and used to train staff and improve the menu.

Customers who give their contact details will receive a reply where one is needed.

RP-12.4 Making a Complaint

A customer who is not satisfied should tell a member of staff straight away, so that the problem can be put right while the customer is still in the restaurant. If the problem cannot be solved on the spot, the customer should ask for the Duty Manager.

Complaints may also be made in writing within 14 days of the visit, quoting the reservation ID or order ID where possible.

RP-12.5 How Complaints Are Handled

Every complaint is recorded. The restaurant will acknowledge a written complaint within 2 business days and reply with its findings and proposed solution within 10 business days. The solution may be an apology, a replacement dish, a refund, a voucher or a combination.

The person who handled the original matter will not be the only person who looks into the complaint.

RP-12.6 Escalation

If a customer is not satisfied with the response of the Duty Manager, they may ask for the matter to be sent to the General Manager. The General Manager will review the case and give a final answer within 10 business days.

Where the matter relates to food safety, discrimination or harassment, it is sent to the General Manager at once.

RP-12.7 Compensation and Goodwill

Where the restaurant has made a mistake, it may offer compensation. This may include a refund of the affected items, a complimentary item, a discount of up to 25 percent on the bill, or a voucher. Compensation above \$100 must be approved by the General Manager.

Compensation is a gesture of goodwill and is not an admission of liability.

RP-12.8 Staff Conduct

Staff must be clean, wear their uniform and name badge and be on time. They must not eat, drink or use their phone in the dining room, and must not ask guests for tips. Staff must treat customer information as confidential under Chapter 9.

A customer who feels that a member of staff has behaved badly should tell the Duty Manager, who will investigate.

RP-12.9 Reviews and Social Media

Customers are free to review the restaurant online. The restaurant will reply to reviews politely and will not offer a refund or a gift in exchange for a change or removal of a review.

Staff may not post about customers on social media in a way that identifies them.

RP-12.10 Accessibility Feedback

The restaurant welcomes comments on how it can be made more accessible. Menus are available in large print and a braille menu can be requested. Staff will read the menu aloud on request.

Customers with a hearing impairment may communicate using writing, and the restaurant has a hearing loop at reception.

Accessibility requests are dealt with as a priority.

Appendix A: Quick Reference Tables

The tables below collect the most frequently used numbers in the manual. If a table and the main text of a chapter disagree, the main text applies.

Table A-1: Key Time Limits

Rule	Limit	Reference
Advance booking window	Up to 60 days ahead	RP-2.3
Minimum notice for a booking	2 hours (4 hours in peak periods)	RP-2.3, RP-2.12
Standard party size	1 to 10 guests (8 in peak periods)	RP-2.4, RP-2.12
Active reservations per customer	3	RP-2.10
Free cancellation	24 hours or more before	RP-3.1
Late cancellation window	2 to 24 hours before	RP-3.2
Table hold time	15 minutes (30 for 8+ guests)	RP-3.7, RP-3.8
Change of guests / date / time	Up to 4 hours before	RP-3.9, RP-3.10
Maximum changes per reservation	2	RP-3.11
Large group notice	72 hours	RP-4.6
Order modification after confirmation	5 minutes	RP-5.4
Takeaway hold time	45 minutes	RP-5.11
Refund processing	5 to 7 business days	RP-7.7
Complaint reply	10 business days	RP-12.5
Customer data retention	24 months	RP-9.9

Table A-2: Key Fees and Charges

Charge	Amount	Reference
Late-cancellation fee	\$5 per guest, max \$50	RP-3.2
No-show / very late cancellation fee	\$10 per guest, max \$100	RP-3.5
Large group deposit	\$15 per guest	RP-4.6
Deposit after repeated no-shows	\$10 per guest	RP-3.6
Service charge (6+ guests)	10 percent	RP-6.6
Table fee (refusing to vacate, peak)	\$10 per guest per 30 minutes	RP-4.12
Delivery charge (orders under \$40)	\$3	RP-5.12
Valet parking	\$5	RP-11.14
Outside cake fee (events)	\$3 per guest	RP-10.6
Extra event time	\$100 per hour	RP-10.8

Table A-3: Reservation Status Reference

Status	Meaning	Can the customer cancel?
Pending	Awaiting confirmation	Yes, no fee
Confirmed	Accepted, table assigned	Yes, fee depends on notice
Seated	Party has arrived	No
Completed	Party has dined and left	No
Cancelled	Withdrawn	Not applicable
No-Show	Party did not arrive	Not applicable

Table A-4: Table Status Reference

Status	Meaning	Can it be assigned?
Available	Free and ready	Yes
Reserved	Held for a reservation	No, except as RP-4.10
Occupied	Party seated	No
Cleaning	Being reset	After cleaning
Maintenance	Out of service	No

Appendix B: Frequently Asked Questions

Each answer states the policy in plain language and gives the clause where the full rule appears.

Reservations

Q. How many hours before a reservation can I cancel without a fee?

You can cancel without a fee up to 24 hours before the reservation time. Any deposit is refunded in full. (RP-3.1)

Q. What happens if I cancel less than 24 hours before my reservation?

If you cancel between 24 hours and 2 hours before, a late-cancellation fee of \$5 per guest applies, up to \$50 per reservation. (RP-3.2)

Q. What happens if I cancel less than 2 hours before my reservation?

It is treated like a no-show: \$10 per guest, up to \$100 per reservation, and any deposit is forfeited. (RP-3.3, RP-3.5)

Q. What is the no-show policy?

If your party does not arrive within 15 minutes of the reservation time and you have not contacted the restaurant, the reservation is marked No-Show, the table is released, and a fee of \$10 per guest (maximum \$100) applies. (RP-3.5)

Q. How long will you hold my table if I am late?

The table is held for 15 minutes. For parties of 8 or more guests it is held for 30 minutes. If you call ahead, the restaurant will normally hold it for up to 30 minutes. (RP-3.7, RP-3.8)

Q. Can I change the number of guests on my reservation?

Yes, up to 4 hours before the reservation, depending on table capacity. An increase of more than 2 guests needs reconfirmation. (RP-3.9)

Q. Can I change the time or date of my reservation?

Yes, up to 4 hours before the original time, if a table is free at the new time. (RP-3.10)

Q. How many times can I change a reservation?

A reservation can be changed twice. After that, you need to cancel and make a new booking. (RP-3.11)

Q. How far ahead can I book?

Up to 60 days ahead, and at least 2 hours ahead (4 hours during peak periods). (RP-2.3, RP-2.12)

Q. What is the maximum party size for a normal reservation?

10 guests (8 guests in peak periods). Parties of 11 to 30 are large groups, and more than 30 is a private event. (RP-2.4, RP-2.12)

Q. How many active reservations can I hold?

A maximum of 3 active reservations at a time, and never two for overlapping times on the same day. (RP-2.10)

Q. How long can I stay at my table?

90 minutes for 1 to 4 guests, 120 minutes for 5 to 8 guests and 150 minutes for 9 or more. (RP-2.7)

Q. Do I have to reconfirm my reservation?

Only for parties of 8 or more, who will be contacted 24 hours before. If there is no response and the booking is less than 6 hours away, the table may be released. (RP-2.9)

Q. What does the status Pending mean on a reservation?

The request has been received but not yet confirmed. The restaurant aims to confirm within 30 minutes. (RP-2.8, RP-3.15)

Q. Can someone else cancel my reservation?

Only if you have authorised them in writing. A reservation belongs to the customer whose ID is on it. (RP-2.1, RP-9.6)

Q. What happens if the restaurant cancels my reservation?

No fee is charged, any deposit is refunded in full, and you will be offered another date and may receive a goodwill gesture. (RP-3.13)

Q. What if I have had repeated no-shows?

After two no-shows in 6 months you must pay a deposit of \$10 per guest for 6 months. After three in 12 months you may be suspended from booking for 90 days. (RP-3.6)

Q. Can I request a specific table?

You may request one, but it cannot be guaranteed. (RP-2.11)

Tables and Groups

Q. What are the table sizes?

The restaurant has tables of 2, 4, 6 and 8 seats. Tables can be combined for bigger parties. (RP-4.2, RP-4.5)

Q. Can a table be given to more guests than its capacity?

No. The capacity of a table is a safety and comfort limit and must never be exceeded. (RP-4.1)

Q. What are the rules for a large group?

Large groups (11 to 30 guests) must book at least 72 hours ahead and pay a deposit of \$15 per guest within 48 hours. (RP-4.6)

Q. What is the cancellation rule for large groups?

Free up to 7 days before. Between 3 and 7 days you lose 50 percent of the deposit. Less than 3 days, you lose all of it. (RP-4.7)

Q. Can the restaurant move me to a different table?

Yes, for safety, maintenance or operational reasons, but the new table will have equal or greater capacity and no fee is charged. (RP-3.12, RP-4.4)

Q. What does the table status Maintenance mean?

The table is out of service and cannot be assigned. (RP-4.3, RP-4.13)

Q. Can walk-in guests be seated at a reserved table?

Only if the reservation time is more than 2 hours away and they agree to leave by then. (RP-4.10)

Q. Is there a fee for staying longer than the dining period?

No, unless in a peak period you refuse a polite request to leave a table that is needed. Then \$10 per guest per extra 30 minutes may apply. (RP-4.12)

Orders and Menu

Q. Can I cancel an order?

Yes, free of charge while it is Pending, or Confirmed and not yet started. Not once it is Preparing, Ready or Completed. (RP-5.5)

Q. Can I change my order after I have placed it?

Yes while Pending, and for up to 5 minutes after it is Confirmed if the kitchen has not started the item. (RP-5.4)

Q. What happens if I cancel while the food is being prepared?

You may be charged up to 100 percent of the cost of the items already cooked, unless the delay was the restaurant's fault. (RP-5.6)

Q. What are the order statuses?

Pending, Confirmed, Preparing, Ready, Completed and Cancelled. (RP-5.3)

Q. How long should my food take?

Starters and drinks within about 15 minutes, main courses within about 30 minutes, and slow-cooked dishes up to 45 minutes. (RP-5.7)

Q. What if my order is late?

If it is more than 20 minutes late, staff will apologise and give a new estimate. After a further 15 minutes you may cancel free of charge or accept a complimentary drink. (RP-5.9)

Q. What is the maximum quantity per item?

20 per order. Orders of over 50 portions in total need 24 hours' notice. (RP-5.2)

Q. What if an item I ordered is not available?

The restaurant will tell you and offer a substitute or remove it. (RP-5.1, RP-6.2)

Q. Do menu prices include tax?

Prices exclude taxes unless the menu says otherwise. A 10 percent service charge applies to parties of 6 or more. (RP-6.4, RP-6.6)

Q. Is the price I see the price I pay if the menu changes?

Yes. The price on the menu at the time of ordering is the price you pay. (RP-6.4)

Q. Is there a delivery charge?

Delivery is available for orders over \$20, with a \$3 charge on orders under \$40. (RP-5.12)

Q. How long is a takeaway order held?

45 minutes after the ready time, after which it may be discarded without a refund. (RP-5.11)

Q. Can I pre-order for my reservation?

Yes. The pre-order is cancelled if the reservation is cancelled. (RP-5.13)

Q. Can the bill be split?

Up to 4 ways for tables of up to 6 guests, and between 2 payers for larger tables. (RP-5.15)

Refunds and Payments

Q. How long does a refund take?

It is started within 2 business days and usually appears within 5 to 7 business days. Cash payments are refunded in cash the same day. (RP-7.7)

Q. Who can approve a refund?

Floor staff up to \$25, a Duty Manager up to \$200, and the General Manager above \$200. (RP-7.8)

Q. Do I get a refund if my food was unsatisfactory?

Tell staff as soon as you notice. The restaurant will replace the dish, offer an alternative or remove it from the bill. (RP-7.4)

Q. Are late-cancellation and no-show fees refundable?

Not if they were correctly charged, except at the discretion of a Duty Manager for illness, accident or bereavement. (RP-3.3, RP-7.9)

Q. What happens if my delivery does not arrive?

You receive a full refund of the order and delivery charge. (RP-7.6)

Q. What payment methods do you accept?

Cash, major cards, digital wallets and bank transfers for advance payments. No personal cheques. (RP-8.1)

Q. How long is a gift card valid?

12 months from purchase. (RP-8.6)

Q. I have an unpaid fee. Can I make a new booking?

Not until the fee is paid, or a deposit equal to it has been given. (RP-8.10)

Customers and Privacy

Q. What information does the restaurant keep about me?

Your customer ID, name, email and phone number, and your reservations, orders, special requests and dietary information. (RP-9.1)

Q. How do you verify who I am?

By your customer ID together with the phone number or email on file. (RP-9.5)

Q. Can I change my phone number or email?

Yes, at any time after verifying your identity. (RP-9.7)

Q. Can you tell my friend if I have a reservation?

No. The restaurant will not discuss a customer's reservation with anyone else. (RP-9.4)

Q. How long is my data kept?

For 24 months after your last visit, then deleted or anonymised. Payment records are kept for 7 years. (RP-9.9)

Q. Can I ask to have my data deleted?

Yes, within 30 days, apart from records the restaurant must keep by law. (RP-9.8)

General Rules

Q. What are your opening hours?

Monday to Thursday 11:00 to 23:00, Friday and Saturday 11:00 to 00:00, Sunday 10:00 to 22:00. (RP-11.1)

Q. When is the last order?

The kitchen takes its last order 45 minutes before closing, and the bar 30 minutes before closing. (RP-11.1)

Q. Are children welcome?

Yes. High chairs are available on request. After 21:00 children under 12 must be accompanied at the table. (RP-11.5)

Q. Can I bring my dog?

Only guide dogs and service animals indoors. Pets are welcome outdoors on a lead. (RP-11.6)

Q. What is the dress code?

Smart casual. A shirt and footwear are required. (RP-11.3)

Q. What is the legal age for alcohol?

Alcohol is served to guests aged 21 and over. (RP-11.12)

Q. How do I make a complaint?

Tell a member of staff or the Duty Manager straight away, or write within 14 days. The restaurant replies within 10 business days. (RP-12.4, RP-12.5)

Q. How long is lost property kept?

30 days. (RP-11.9)

Appendix C: Worked Examples

These examples show how the policies apply when a customer's record, reservation or order is combined with the rules in this manual.

Scenario 1: Cancelling a reservation the day before

A customer with ID C005 has a reservation (status Confirmed) for 4 guests on Saturday at 19:30. On Friday at 17:00, which is 26.5 hours before, the customer asks to cancel. Because this is more than 24 hours before the reservation, no fee applies. The reservation status becomes Cancelled, the table is released, and any deposit is refunded in full.

Policies used: RP-3.1, RP-3.4, RP-7.2.

Scenario 2: Cancelling the same afternoon

The same reservation is cancelled on Saturday at 15:30, which is 4 hours before the reservation. This is a late cancellation. The fee is \$5 per guest for 4 guests, which is \$20. If a deposit was paid, \$20 is deducted and the balance is refunded. If there was no deposit, the \$20 is recorded on the customer record.

Policies used: RP-3.2, RP-8.10.

Scenario 3: Cancelling one hour before

A customer with a reservation for 6 guests cancels 1 hour before. This is less than 2 hours, so it is charged as a no-show: \$10 per guest would be \$60, within the maximum of \$100. Any deposit is forfeited. A Duty Manager may waive the fee if the customer was ill or had an emergency and gives reasonable evidence.

Policies used: RP-3.3, RP-3.5.

Scenario 4: Party does not arrive

A party of 3 booked for 20:00 has not arrived or telephoned by 20:15. The table is released, the status becomes No-Show, and a fee of \$30 is recorded. The customer is now subject to the repeated no-show rule if there are further no-shows within 6 months.

Policies used: RP-3.5, RP-3.6.

Scenario 5: Party is 20 minutes late and called ahead

A customer telephones at 19:45 to say that their party will arrive at about 20:20 for a 20:00 reservation. If the restaurant is not full, it will hold the table, as it normally holds tables for up to 30 minutes when told in advance. If the table has been given to a walk-in, the restaurant will try to seat the party at another table.

Policies used: RP-3.7.

Scenario 6: Increasing the number of guests

A customer with a table for 4 wants to bring 3 more guests, 6 hours before the booking. The change is allowed because it is more than 4 hours before, but because it is an increase of more than 2 guests it needs reconfirmation. The restaurant checks whether a table of 8 seats is free. If so, the party is moved. If not, the customer is offered another time.

Policies used: RP-3.9, RP-4.2, RP-3.12.

Scenario 7: Third change to a reservation

A customer has already changed a reservation twice and wants to change the time again. The restaurant cannot make a third change. The customer may cancel and make a new booking, which may be subject to cancellation fees depending on how far ahead the cancellation is.

Policies used: RP-3.11.

Scenario 8: Cancelling an order that is already cooking

A customer orders a main course, and 5 minutes later the status becomes Preparing. The customer asks to cancel. The customer cannot cancel the order. If the restaurant agrees to cancel, the customer may be charged up to the full price of the item. If the customer had waited more than 20 minutes beyond the target time, they could cancel for free.

Policies used: RP-5.5, RP-5.6, RP-5.9.

Scenario 9: Adding a dessert

While the main course order is Preparing, the customer asks to add a dessert. This is allowed. The dessert is treated as a new order with its own order ID and status, and is not affected by the status of the first order.

Policies used: RP-5.4.

Scenario 10: A large group booking

A customer wants to book for 18 guests next Friday evening. This is a large group and a peak period. It must be booked at least 72 hours ahead, the menu agreed 48 hours ahead, and a deposit of \$270 (18 times \$15) paid within 48 hours. A 10 percent service charge applies. If the customer cancels 5 days before, 50 percent of the deposit (\$135) is forfeited.

Policies used: RP-4.6, RP-4.7, RP-6.6, RP-2.12.

Scenario 11: Someone else asks about a booking

A caller says that their friend, customer C012, has a reservation and asks for the time. The restaurant does not confirm whether a reservation exists, and asks the caller to have the customer contact the restaurant.

Policies used: RP-9.4, RP-9.6.

Scenario 12: A refund for a delivery that never came

A customer paid \$38 online for a delivery that did not arrive within 45 minutes after the estimated time. The customer is entitled to a full refund of the food and the \$3 delivery charge, which is initiated within 2 business days and should appear in 5 to 7 business days. A Duty Manager approves the refund because it is over \$25 in total.

Policies used: RP-7.6, RP-7.7, RP-7.8.

Appendix D: Staff Checklists

Checklists for staff who handle reservations, orders and refunds.

Front Desk Checklist: Taking a Reservation

- Confirm that the caller is an existing customer or create a customer record with name, phone and email.
- Check that the date is within 60 days and the time is at least 2 hours away (4 hours in peak periods).
- Check the number of guests: 1 to 10 standard, 11 to 30 large group, over 30 private event.
- Check that the customer does not already hold 3 active reservations or an overlapping booking.
- Check that the customer has no unpaid late-cancellation or no-show fee.
- Choose a table whose capacity is equal to or greater than the number of guests.
- Record special requests, allergies and accessibility needs.
- Give the customer the reservation ID, date, time, guests and table, and explain the 24-hour cancellation rule and 15-minute hold.
- Set the status to Confirmed, or Pending if it needs manager approval.

Front Desk Checklist: Cancelling a Reservation

- Verify the customer with the customer ID and phone or email.
- Find the reservation and its date and time.
- Calculate the hours between now and the reservation time.
- Apply the fee table: 24 hours or more is free, 2 to 24 hours is \$5 per guest, under 2 hours is \$10 per guest.
- Set the status to Cancelled and release the table.
- Process any deposit refund or record any fee on the customer record.
- Send the cancellation confirmation.

Kitchen Checklist: Receiving an Order

- Check the order for allergy and dietary notes before accepting it.
- Check that each item is marked as available.
- Set the status to Confirmed and give the estimated time.
- Do not accept a modification once an item has started cooking, except to add new items.
- Set the status to Preparing when cooking begins and Ready when it is finished.
- Tell the floor team at once if an item is delayed beyond the target time.

Manager Checklist: Waiving a Fee or Refunding

- Check the reason for the waiver and, where possible, the evidence.
- Check the amount against your approval limit.
- Record the reservation or order ID, the amount, the reason and your name.
- Tell the customer the outcome and, for refunds, how long they should expect to wait.
- Review the customer's history for repeated waivers.

Appendix E: Glossary

Table E-1: Defined Terms

Term	Meaning
Active reservation	A reservation with status Pending or Confirmed whose date has not passed.
Business day	A day on which the restaurant is open to the public, excluding closed public holidays.
Cancelled (reservation)	A reservation withdrawn by the customer or the restaurant.
Capacity	The largest number of guests that a table can seat.
Completed (order)	An order that has been served or collected and paid for.
Completed (reservation)	A reservation where the party has dined and left.
Confirmed (reservation)	A reservation accepted by the restaurant, with a table assigned.
Customer ID	The unique code for a customer record, for example C005.
Deposit	An advance payment that is deducted from the final bill or refunded as the policy states.
Duty Manager	The manager in charge of the restaurant during a shift.
Guest	Any person who dines, including children.
Item ID	The unique code for a menu item.
Large group	A party of 11 to 30 guests.
Late cancellation	A cancellation less than 24 hours but at least 2 hours before a reservation.
No-Show	A reservation where the party did not arrive within 15 minutes and did not contact the restaurant.
Order ID	The unique code for an order.
Peak period	Friday and Saturday evenings, public holidays and festival days.
Pending	Received but not yet confirmed (reservation) or accepted (order).
Preparing	An order that the kitchen is cooking.
Private event	A booking of more than 30 guests or exclusive use of a space.
Reservation ID	The unique code for a reservation.
Seated	A reservation where the party has arrived and is being served.
Service charge	A 10 percent charge added to parties of 6 or more.
Table ID	The unique code for a table.
Table number	The number marked on a physical table.
Walk-in	A guest who arrives without a reservation.

Appendix F: Contacts and Revision History

Table F-1: Escalation Contacts

Level	Role	When to contact
1	Floor team member	Everyday questions, small refunds up to \$25
2	Duty Manager	Fee waivers, refunds up to \$200, complaints on the day
3	General Manager	Refunds over \$200, appeals, food safety, discrimination
4	Events Coordinator	Private events and corporate accounts

Table F-2: Revision History

Version	Date	Change
1.0	October 6, 2026	First edition of the Restaurant Policy Manual

End of manual.